CPG Distributor Management SaaS Implementation

Procurement support, requirements, implementation and UAT

Prepared by Chinmayee Surwade

Purpose and evidence boundary

This package demonstrates BA preparation for a consumer packaged goods SaaS implementation. Sundara Foods, its distributors, requirements, prices and vendor responses are fictional. Documents are authored examples, not evidence of a live implementation, procurement award, client meeting or realised business improvement. Manual prototype UAT and client role-play are still pending. The prototype implements order, pricing and credit checks only; the broader implementation scope remains a design exercise.

Business case

Sundara Foods sells packaged snacks through distributors to retailers. Pilot assumption: 3 distributors, 20 users, 4 SKUs, one currency (INR) and carton-based ordering.

Orders currently arrive by email and phone; sales operations rekeys them, finance checks credit manually and warehouse staff confirm stock separately. The proposed SaaS workflow consolidates capture, approval and fulfilment visibility.

Illustrative targets, not results:

- Reduce manual order handling from 15 to 8 minutes.
- Achieve 98% valid orders at first submission.
- Reconcile 100% of migrated opening balances.
- Give each pilot distributor access only to its own orders.

Baselines must be measured before a real rollout.

Scope and assumptions

Pilot includes distributor/product masters, orders, scheme pricing, credit holds, stock reservation, deliveries, return controls and reports.

GST, ERP invoicing, offline operation, complex trade promotion accruals, route optimisation and production authentication are outside the prototype.

Real procurement should confirm tax handling, security and integration before vendor selection.

Domain cheat sheet

2lightbluewhite

Term	Meaning in this case
Primary sales	Manufacturer sells stock to a distributor.
Secondary sales	Distributor sells stock to a retailer; this pilot models secondary orders.
SKU	A distinct product/pack combination.
Scheme	An agreed trade incentive, here a line-level quantity discount.
Credit exposure	Unpaid balance plus committed order value; production needs pending-order exposure controls.
Fill rate	Delivered cartons / ordered cartons for eligible non-cancelled orders.
Saleable return	Approved returned goods that can be put back into available inventory.

Discovery workshop pack

2lightbluewhite

Stakeholder	Questions to ask	Decision/output
Sales operations	How are orders captured? Which prices apply by territory? Can schemes overlap?	Order fields and price rules
Distributor	Who places orders? What approval delays occur? What status visibility is needed?	User journey and training needs
Finance	What counts as exposure? Who can approve exceptions? What is the audit requirement?	Credit workflow and role matrix
Warehouse	What is the unit of measure? Can orders be partially filled? How are returns graded?	Stock and return rules
IT/data steward	Which ERP owns invoices? What keys and refresh frequency exist?	Mapping and integration contract

Simulated decisions for this design, not meeting minutes: carton unit only; 5% line discount at 10 cartons; no partial fulfilment; finance-only credit release; damaged stock quarantined; warehouse dispatch after reservation.

Open items: GST calculation, ERP endpoint contract, tenancy model, security review and return credit-note reconciliation.

AS-IS and TO-BE

2lightbluewhite

Step	AS-IS assumed pain	TO-BE design
Capture	Email/phone; missing SKU codes	Validate master references and quantities on entry
Price	Manual rate lookup	Effective price and scheme calculation
Credit	Separate finance email	Automatic hold; reason and approver recorded
Stock	Phone confirmation	Check available stock; reserve after clearance
Dispatch	Separate spreadsheet update	One dispatch event updates stock and status
Return	Unlinked return records	Link to delivered line; prevent excess return
Reporting	Manual consolidation	Order and inventory measures from consistent keys

Requirements and acceptance criteria

2lightbluewhite

ID	Capability / owner	Acceptance criterion
REQ01	Order capture / Distributor	Create an order with active SKUs and positive integer carton quantities; inactive products cannot be submitted.
REQ02	Pricing and schemes / Sales operations	Use effective carton price; apply 5% discount when an order line has at least 10 cartons. No stacked discounts.
REQ03	Credit control / Finance	Hold an order when outstanding exposure plus net order value exceeds the limit; finance approval is required to release it.
REQ04	Inventory reservation / Warehouse	Reserve stock only after credit clearance; available stock equals on-hand minus reserved. Reject insufficient stock; no partial fulfilment in pilot.
REQ05	Delivery / Warehouse	Dispatch reduces on-hand and releases the same reservation; a second dispatch request must not change stock.

ID	Capability / owner	Acceptance criterion
REQ06	Returns / Warehouse	Return quantity cannot exceed delivered less previously returned; saleable approved returns increase stock; damaged returns are quarantined.
REQ07	Access control / Administrator	Distributor sees only its own orders. Finance releases credit holds; warehouse dispatches. Record actor, time and before/after status.
REQ08	Migration / Data steward	Reject duplicate keys and missing references; reconcile record counts, opening stock and outstanding balances before import approval.
REQ09	Reporting / Sales manager	Report order net value, fulfilled cartons divided by ordered cartons, held orders, and available stock by SKU. Exclude cancelled orders.
REQ10	Integration / IT	ERP remains invoice/accounting source. Use unique order ID and retry-safe imports; put failed records into an exception queue.

RFI: vendor capability questionnaire

Purpose: shortlist vendors before detailed proposals. Send the same questions to each vendor and request evidence, not just Yes/No. All response examples in the workbook are mock.

2lightbluewhite

Question	Required evidence
Support distributor, retailer and SKU hierarchies?	Demo of master-data relationships and bulk import
Provide order pricing, quantity schemes and credit holds?	Live scenario walkthrough with boundary cases
Support tenant isolation and role permissions?	Role matrix, tenant design and independent security assurance
Offer ERP APIs and retry-safe imports?	API documentation, authentication, idempotency and error handling
Support stock reservation, deliveries and returns?	Inventory ledger demo and return controls
Provide audit logs, backups and restore?	Retention policy, restore test and access logging
Offer exports and contract exit support?	Sample exports, formats and transition terms
Provide deployment and training support?	Project plan, support hours and escalation commitments

RFP: implementation proposal request

Business objective: implement the ten requirements for a 3-distributor pilot with 20 users.

Vendors should distinguish standard configuration, custom development, third-party dependency and unavailable capability for every requirement. Require a demonstration using the supplied sample data.

Required response:

- Requirements matrix
- Solution architecture
- Migration approach
- Integration contract
- Role/security model
- 6-week delivery plan
- Assumptions/dependencies
- Support SLA
- Commercial schedule
- Training plan
- Acceptance approach
- Data export and exit arrangements

Proposed timetable: questions by working day 5, response by day 10, demo by day 15. These dates are relative planning assumptions.

Mandatory gates: distributor data isolation, finance-only release, exportability, audit evidence and successful sample-data import.

A failed gate removes the vendor regardless of score.

Scoring:

- Functional fit: 35%
- Integration: 20%
- Security: 20%
- Implementation/support: 15%
- Commercial clarity: 10%

Each criterion is scored 1–5 using evidence.

$$WeightedScore = \frac{\sum(Weight \times Score)}{5}$$

RFQ: cost request

Request INR prices for 20 users over 36 months:

- Per-user monthly licence
- One-time configuration
- Migration
- Integration
- Training
- Annual support
- Optional changes

Confirm licence minimums, price increases, taxes, payment milestones, exclusions and exit charges.

The workbook provides three fictional quotes with formula-based 3-year totals. Costs are assumptions, not actual vendor quotations.

Mock procurement recommendation

Vendor A: balanced functional/integration fit.

Vendor B: lower assumed price but weaker integration.

Vendor C: stronger functionality at higher assumed cost.

All pass only simulated gates. Prefer Vendor A provisionally on weighted fit after validating evidence.

Do not award on this simulation; cost, mandatory gates and actual demos must be reviewed together.

Implementation design and six-week plan

2lightbluewhite

Week	Activities	Review gate / owner
1	Discovery; agree scope, requirements and success measures	Business owner approves baseline
2	Configure masters, roles, scheme and credit rules	BA and finance approve rule walkthrough
3	Mock migration; map ERP fields; resolve rejected rows	Data steward approves reconciliations
4	System/integration testing; distributor demo	IT confirms key scenarios and access checks
5	Business UAT; training; fix and retest defects	Business owners approve evidence
6	Pilot cutover; daily issue triage; transition	Sponsor approves go-live and support handover

Role and configuration matrix

2lightbluewhite

Role	Allowed	Restricted
Distributor	Own order create/view	Other distributor records, price master edits, credit release
Sales operations	Review orders; maintain approved commercial rules	Finance approvals
Finance	View exposure; release/reject credit holds with reason	Warehouse stock edits
Warehouse	Reserve/dispatch; inspect returns	Credit release and price edits
Administrator	User and reference-data administration	Approval decisions without business authority

Data migration and integration

Migration sequence:

Products and distributors, retailer relationships, inventory, outstanding balances, then open orders.

Use staging, reject reports and corrected reruns. Preserve source IDs; reconcile record counts plus stock and balance totals. The Migration sheet defines field-level mappings and error actions.

Production imports need atomic transactions and protection against duplicates.

Proposed ERP contract:

- order_id
- distributor_id
- retailer_id
- sku_id
- cartons
- net_value
- currency
- event_time
- event_type

ERP returns acknowledgement, invoice reference or error code.

Retry the same event with the same unique key; do not create a second financial posting.

Outage handling: queue with status and retry count, reconcile before manual release.

The prototype does not connect to an ERP.

Worked order and stock example

D001 orders 10 cartons of SKU01 at INR 1,000/carton.

- Gross = INR 10,000
- 5% scheme = INR 500
- Net = INR 9,500 before taxes
- Opening unpaid balance = INR 42,000
- Credit limit = INR 50,000
- Projected exposure = INR 51,500

Result: CREDIT HOLD.

Stock is not reserved.

After an authorised finance release, on-hand 30 and reserved 5 permit reserving 10, so reserved becomes 15 and available 15.

Dispatch changes on-hand to 20 and reserved to 5.

An approved saleable return of 2 increases on-hand to 22. A damaged return goes to quarantine, not saleable stock.

UAT, traceability and defects

The workbook contains test inputs, expected results and requirement references.

Execution status is **Not run**; actual results, evidence and sign-off are intentionally blank.

Open the prototype locally to execute the order/pricing/credit cases. Use an implementation or guided spreadsheet walkthrough for other design cases; that is not a live SaaS system test.

Proposed entry criteria

- Configured test environment
- Accepted sample-data import
- Stable interfaces
- Trained testers
- Approved test cases

Proposed exit criteria

- All critical cases passed with evidence
- No unresolved critical/high defects
- Remaining lower defects have an owner and accepted workaround
- Business owners approve sign-off

These are project criteria, not achieved results.

Defect template

ID, linked test, severity, steps, expected/actual result, screenshot or log, owner, status, fix version and retest outcome.

Include duplicate events, unauthorised access, insufficient stock and over-return tests.

A sample pricing defect is labelled hypothetical in the workbook.

Training and client walkthrough

Agenda:

- 5 minutes: business problem
- 5 minutes: order creation and scheme
- 5 minutes: credit hold and role controls
- 5 minutes: inventory, delivery and returns
- 5 minutes: reporting and feedback

Explain the distributor journey first, then configuration.

Ask a peer to play distributor/finance and complete the Feedback sheet. Do not present the simulation as a client workshop.

Distributor quick guide

Select your account and active SKU; enter cartons; review scheme/net value; submit. A credit hold needs finance review.

Warehouse quick guide

Check approved status and available stock; reserve; dispatch once; link returns to delivery and classify condition.

Finance quick guide

Inspect exposure and hold reason; record approval/rejection and audit reason.

Cutover, rollback and support

Before go-live

- Freeze source edits.
- Back up/export masters and balances.
- Reconcile final import.
- Confirm roles.
- Execute smoke tests.
- Obtain sponsor approval.

Stop cutover if balances differ, access isolation fails or critical cases fail.

Rollback

Disable order submission, preserve transaction exports, reconcile any ERP postings, restore validated configuration/data under IT control and resume agreed manual capture.

Avoid blindly restoring over financial transactions.

Pilot support

Daily triage by BA, IT, finance and warehouse; assign issue owner and target response; review held orders and import failures.

Proposed hypercare is 5 working days.

Sponsor decides acceptance using evidence, not the illustrative targets alone.

Interview explanation and resume use

After reviewing and completing the walkthrough, describe this as an **independent portfolio simulation**:

> I designed a distributor-management implementation case study, prepared RFI/RFP/RFQ examples, compared mock vendors, mapped data and created UAT scenarios for pricing, credit and inventory controls. I can demonstrate the order-check prototype and explain the implementation plan. It was not a paid CPG implementation.

Resume wording after review

CPG Distributor Management SaaS | Independent Portfolio Project

Prepared procurement support documents, configuration requirements, migration mappings and UAT scenarios for a simulated distributor ordering workflow. Created an order-validation prototype covering quantity schemes, stock availability and credit holds.

Sources and design provenance

- Salesforce Consumer Goods Cloud overview: Salesforce Consumer Goods Cloud
- Salesforce Retail Execution Order Management: Retail Execution Order Management

Reviewed 6 October 2026.

These sources explain industry capabilities and distributor fulfilment context. All project rules, vendor scores, data and targets are independently invented assumptions; no Salesforce configuration or deployment is claimed.